

Understanding Facetune churn among Gen Z female users

UR Team Nov '25 

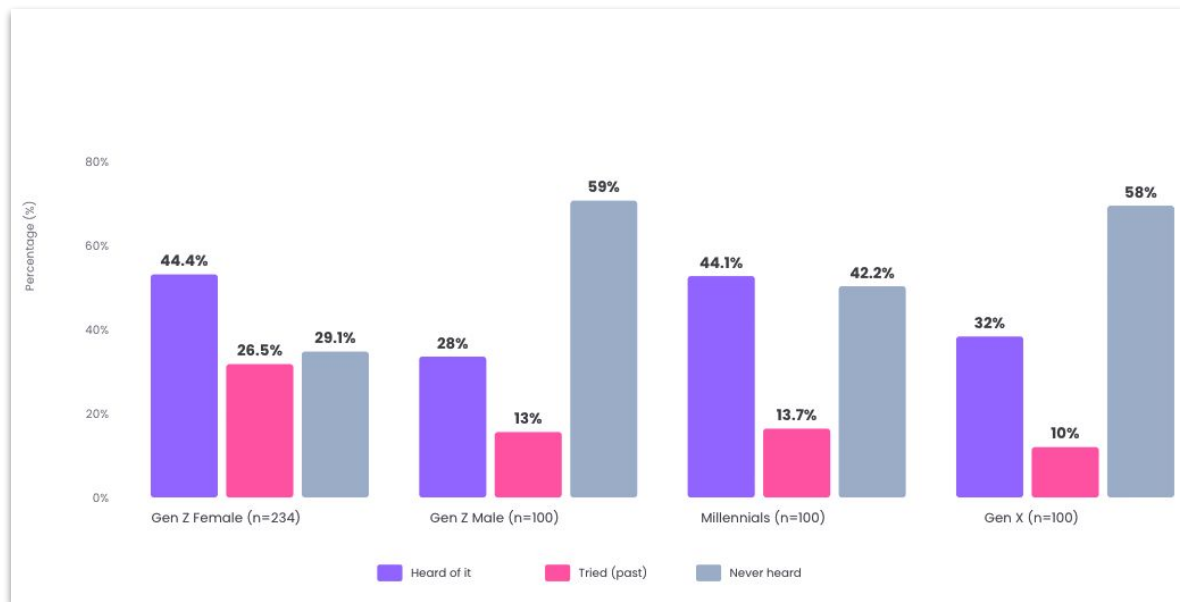
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Background

Over multiple surveys, we explored the editing behaviors, motivations, and preferences of **new audiences across different ages** to better understand how Facetune can attract and resonate with them.

Across 536 participants who are not FT or Faceapp users – use apps like VSCO, Tezza, Adobe Lightroom, or Instagram's tools, it was found that 26.5% of Gen Z females reported trying Facetune but stopping.

Facetune awareness & usage across demographics



- **Gen Z females** show the **highest awareness** and **past use**
- **Gen Z males** and **Gen X** show **low brand recognition**

‘What word comes to mind when you think of FT?’

Key Insights:

- Functional associations dominate: "**Face**" (160) and "**Editing**" (150) account for 58% of keyword mentions.
- Authenticity concerns** were noted in **12.9%** of responses, with participants using words such as **fake**, **catfish**, artificial, plastic, unnatural, and inauthentic.
- Millennials** show **highest** authenticity concern with **18% mentions** compared to:
 - 15.4% Gen Z Females
 - 9% Gen X
 - 5.9% Gen Z Male



What was the goal of this research?

- 1) Understand what led Gen Z female users to stop using Facetune.
- 2) Identify which Facetune features or tools they used most.
- 3) Explore what aspects of the product didn't work or meet expectations.
- 4) Uncover emotional or perceptual barriers (e.g., authenticity, natural look, cost concerns).

What was done?

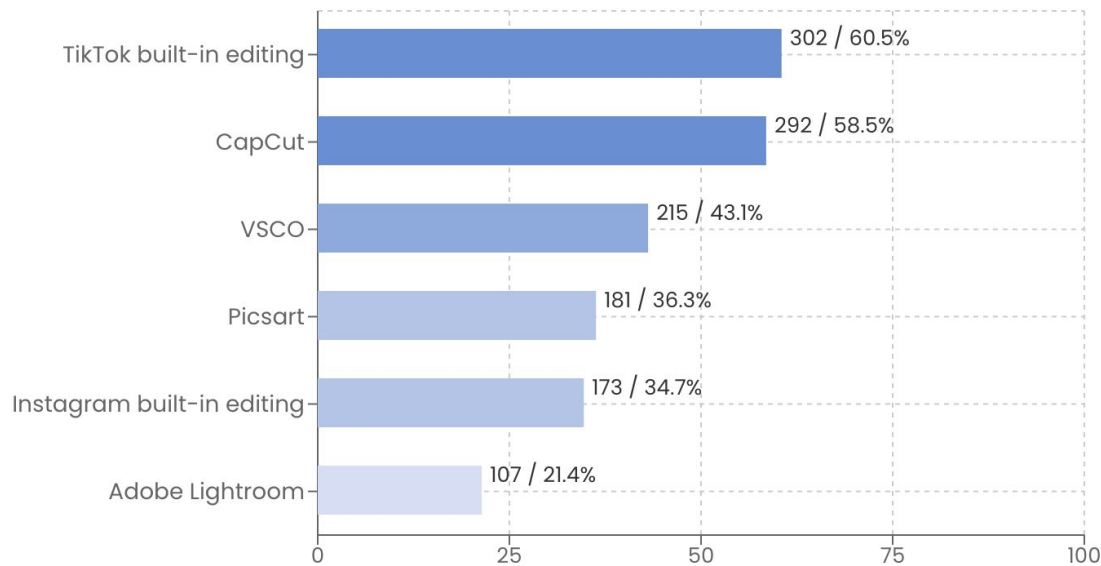
Method:

A quantitative survey with multiple-choice questions informed by prior research, followed by open-ended questions.

Audience:

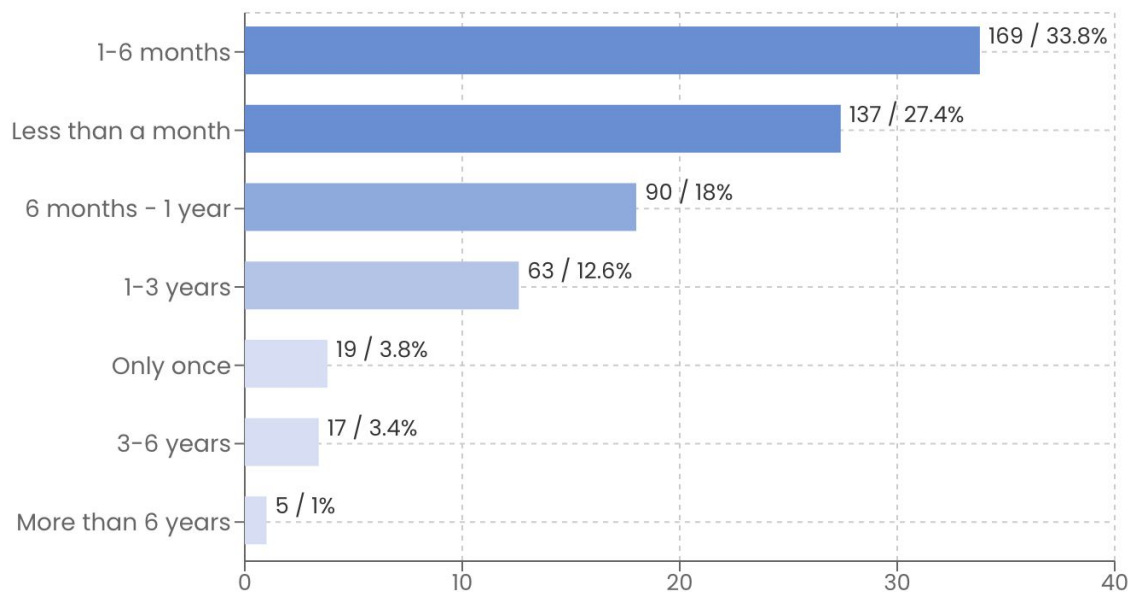
500 Gen Z females (18–27) who previously used Facetune but churned, currently using other editing apps (such as VSCO, Tezza, etc.)

Churned users now heavily use **TikTok** (60.5%), **CapCut** (58.5%), and **VSCO** (43.1%) for their editing needs



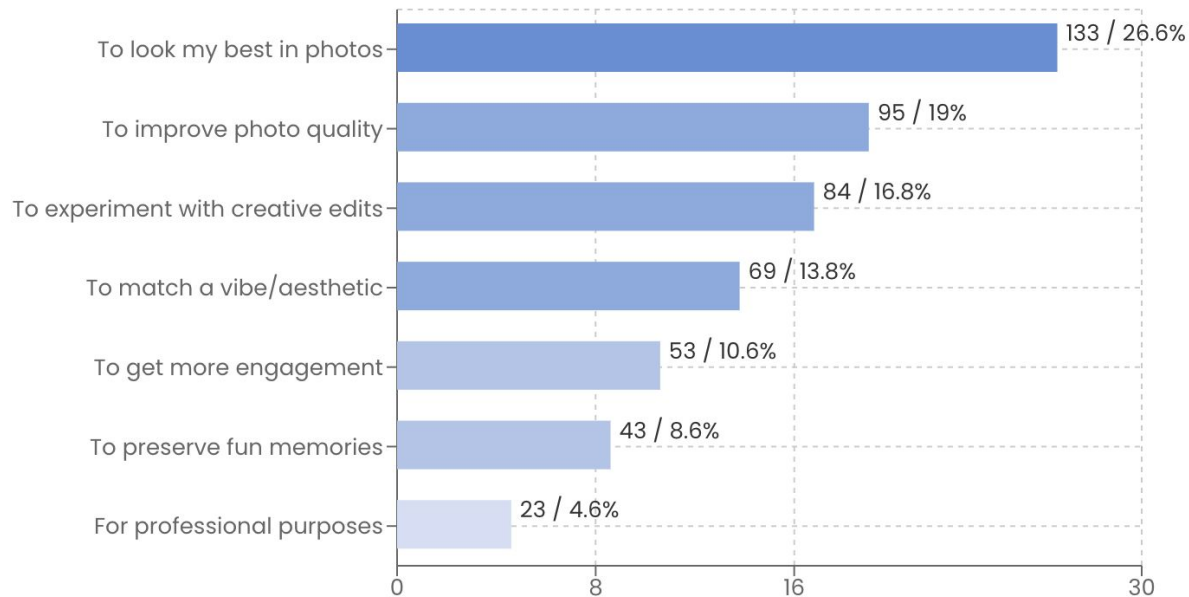
- **TikTok** (60.5%) and **CapCut** (58.5%) are statistically tied as the **top editing apps**, significantly higher than all other apps
- **VSCO** (43.1%) is **significantly higher** than Picsart and Instagram

61% of users churned within the first 6 months, suggesting early dissatisfaction or unmet expectations



1-6 months (33.8%) and **Less than a month** (27.4%) are statistically tied as the top periods - **both significantly higher** than all others

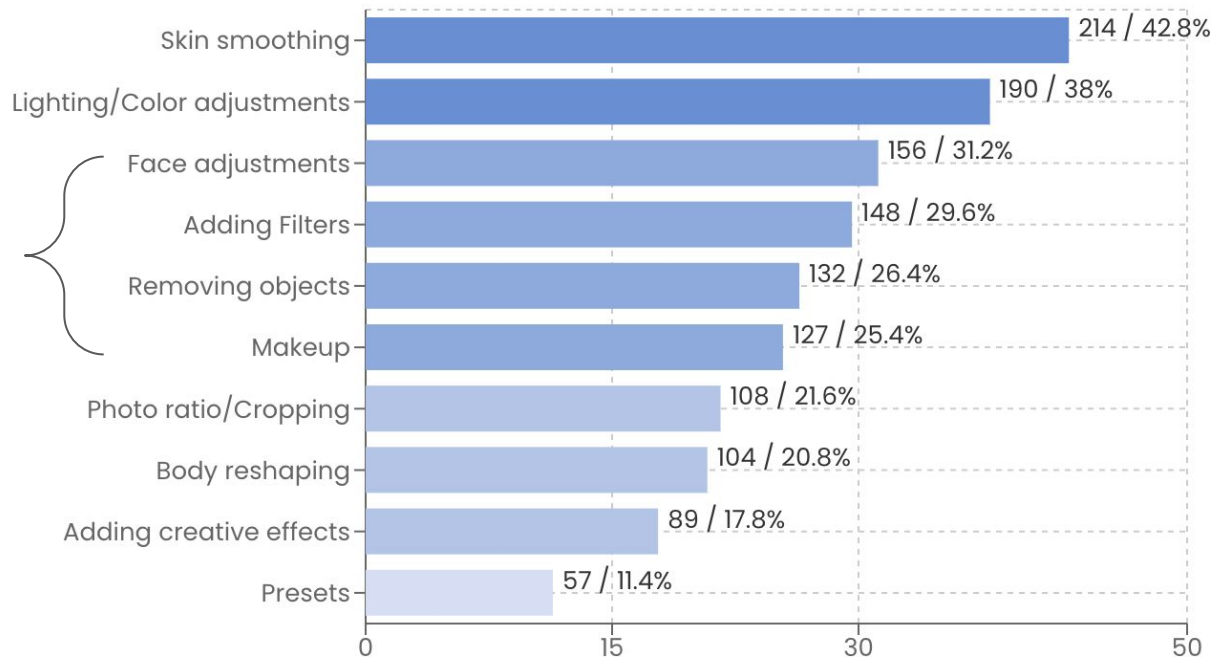
Users **main goal** for using Facetune was **'To look my best'**



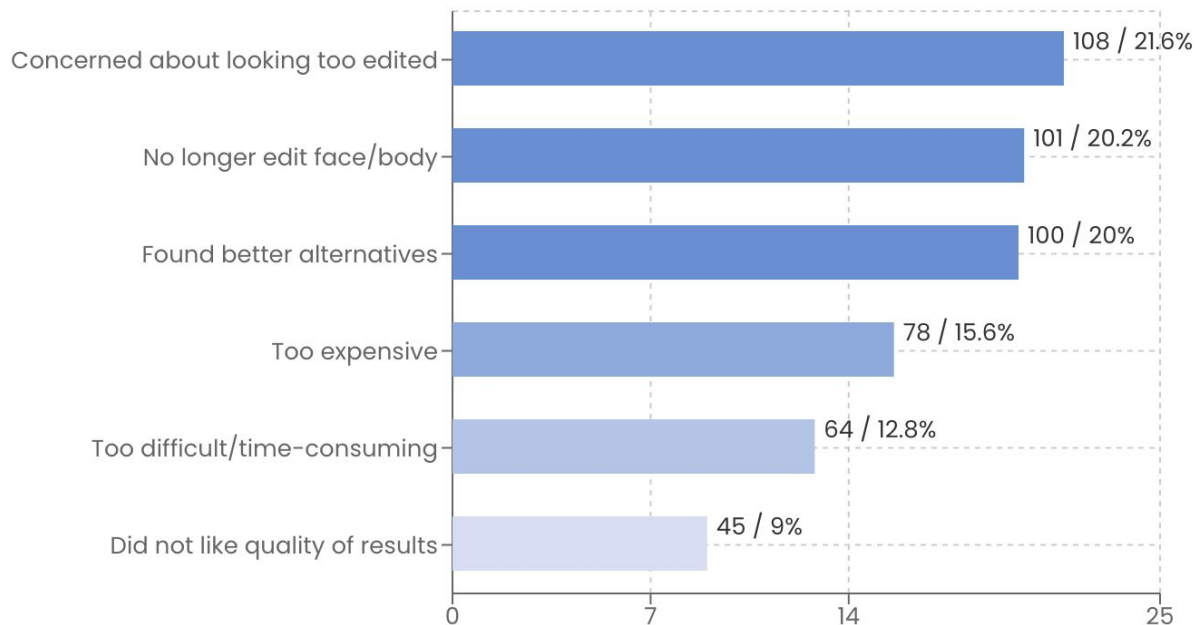
- **To look my best** (26.6%) is **significantly higher** than all other goals
- 3 goals are **statistically tied** in the middle tier: **improve quality** (19%), **experiment** (16.8%), **match aesthetic** (13.8%)

Churned users most frequently used skin smoothing and lighting/color adjustments – statistically tied

Form a statistically tied middle tier

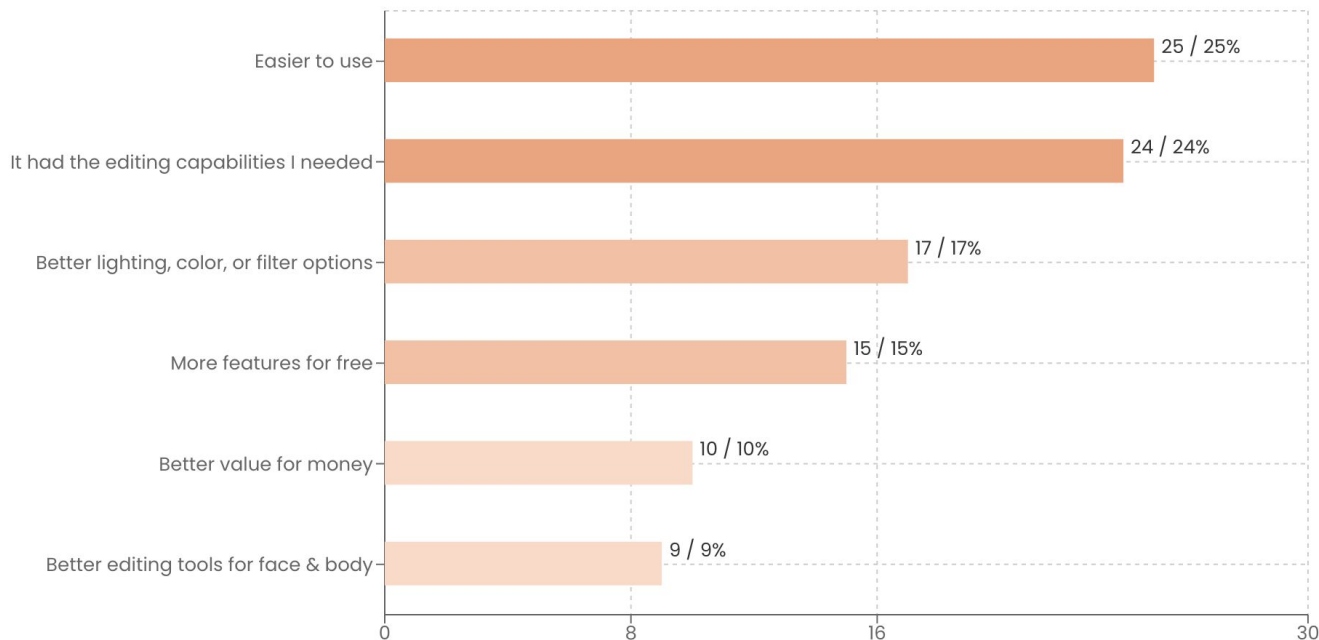


Top 3 churn drivers are statistically tied:
Authenticity concerns, no longer edit face / body, found
better alternatives



Follow-up: What makes other apps Better?

100 participants who found better alternatives selected 'Easier to use' (25%) and 'Having needed editing capabilities' (24%) as top reasons – statistically tied



Follow-up: What makes other apps Better? – main themes

More comprehensive features

*"What I mean is, apps like CapCut let me turn photos and short videos into a complete little piece of content, whereas **Facetune doesn't bother with any of that – it just focuses on the face**"*

VSCO / Lightroom for better filters and color editing

*"VSCO offers better filters that **feel more natural**..."VSCO they emphasize creating a 'specific' look"*

*"I preferred Lightroom since its advanced color grading sliders provided **detailed control that Facetune basic tools never offered**"*

Follow-up: What makes other apps Better? – main themes

Free or low-cost apps

"FaceApp has **better value for your money**. The prices are cheaper"

"Capcut and picsart offers more filters and editing tools **for free or for a lower cost** than FaceTune"

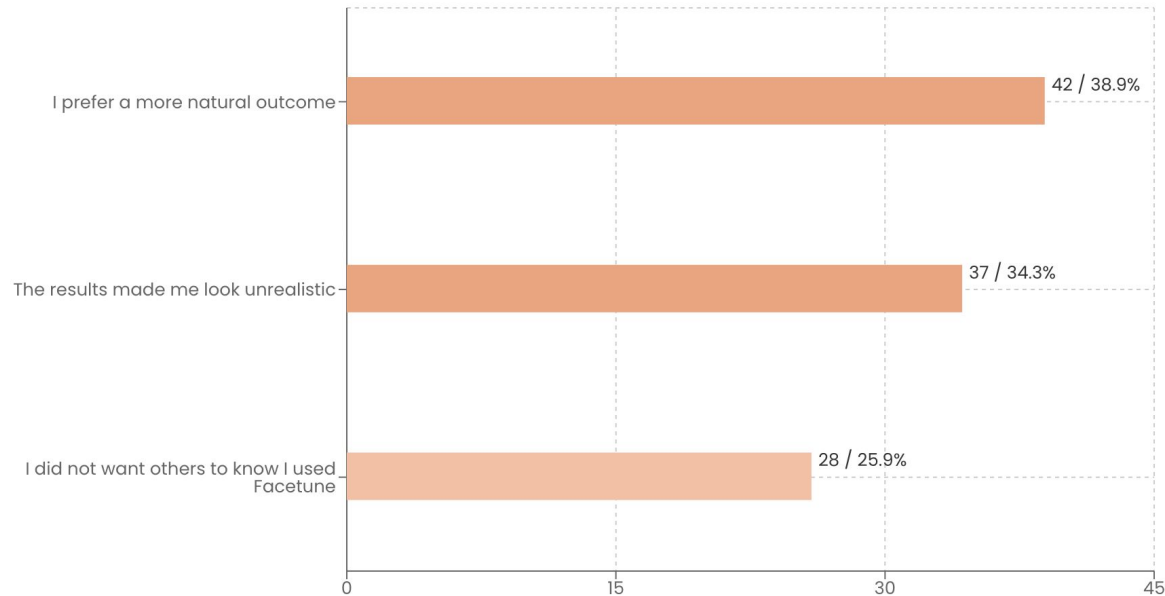
Apps focused on creativity rather than altering appearance

"Picsart, or honestly any other app. **I think my problem is what facetune is based in (altering physical look)** so id rather use something that's more about creativity"

"I moved to Picsart since its creative overlays allowed more artistic freedom that **Facetune's beauty focused tools couldn't match**"

Follow-up: Understanding Authenticity Concerns

108 participants concerned about looking too edited or fake – ‘Prefer natural outcome’ (38.9%) and ‘Results look unrealistic’ (34.3%) are statistically tied as the main authenticity concerns



Follow-up: Understanding authenticity concerns – main themes

Social Consequences: Fear of judgment and embarrassment

The external pressure – what others will think

"It is embarrassing to be caught editing photos"

"What if people started spreading rumors that I either got plastic surgery or I edited my photos"

Identity Disconnect: Not looking like themselves IRL

The catfish concern – online vs. offline mismatch

"Didn't want to seem like a catfish since people i knew in real life followed me on social media"

"I realized I looked really different than how I look in real life and I was scared of people realizing I was fake looking"

Follow-up: Understanding authenticity concerns – main themes

Too perfect to feel real

Wanting to see results with texture and their skin and elements

"My skin was too smooth too perfect I didn't look real at all"

"When retouching the photograph, the skin suddenly became a uniform glossy surface, as if waxed, with all texture completely lost"

Desired Outcome: Subtle enhancement, not transformation

What they actually want instead

"A more natural outcome meaning that my picture is edited but nobody can tell"

"looking more natural, having imperfections is okay"

Recommendations

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- **Address early churn** – Improve onboarding, set expectations, focus on retention in first 6 months
- **Reframe brand positioning around authenticity** – Rebrand messaging away from dramatic transformation toward "natural enhancement"
 - Add tools that help users maintain a natural outcome
- **Address the "Too Perfect" problem** – Users are churning because results looked fake / plastic, we should help them achieve subtle and authentic results
- **Expand beyond face and body editing** – Invest in comprehensive vibe and aesthetic features that allow users to achieve a "complete" photo outcome